not exist, and things are nowhere – is not something that estranges us from our true selves, for this is only what our natural curiosity reveals to us about the place of our dwelling. About the stuff of which we ourselves are made. We are made of the same stardust of which all things are made, and when we are immersed in suffering or when we are experiencing intense joy we are being nothing other than what we can't help but be: a part of our world.

Lucretius expresses this, wonderfully:

> … we are all born from the same celestial seed;
> all of us have the same father,
> from which the earth, the mother who feeds us,
> receives clear drops of rain,
> producing from them bright wheat
> and lush trees,
> and the human race,
> and the species of beasts,
> offering up the foods with which all bodies are nourished,
> to lead a sweet life
> and generate offspring …
>
> (II, 991–7)

It is part of our nature to love and to be honest. It is part of our nature to long to know more, and to continue to learn. Our knowledge of the world continues to grow.

There are frontiers where we are learning, and our desire for knowledge burns. They are in the most minute reaches of the fabric of space, at the origins of the cosmos, in the nature of time, in the phenomenon of black holes, and in the workings of our own thought processes. Here, on the edge of what we know, in contact with the ocean of the unknown, shines the mystery and the beauty of the world. And it's breathtaking.